



△ E 2000 LADDER what the numbers mean

- **<1.0** Dead match. Don't chase it.
- **1 – 2** Commercial match. Most jobs pass here.
- **2 – 3.5** Visible side by side. Correct if the client will see both.
- **>3.5** The client will see it. Correct before you run the job.

△ COMMON DRIFT → WHAT TO MOVE when your Lab reading drifts, the fix is almost always one ink

DRIFT (vs. target)	FIRST MOVE	IF STILL OFF
+a (too red)	pull magenta	or add a touch of cyan
-a (too green)	pull cyan	or add a touch of magenta
+b (too yellow)	pull yellow	or add magenta on warm stock
-b (too blue)	pull cyan	or add a touch of yellow
-L (too dark)	pull K first	then pull all four if still heavy
+L (too light)	add CMY proportional	K last, sparingly

△ FIRST, CHECK THE MATERIAL (the paper or substrate)

You are not printing on white. Every substrate shifts the color on it. Before you blame the build, measure the bare stock. If it's cyan, you can't hit warm colors by piling on more ink.

No amount of yellow fixes a cyan substrate. Diagnose where the cast lives first.

△ GRAY BALANCE BUILDS common neutral CMY targets by paper

COATED (GRACoL)

25%	C 25	M 19	Y 19
50%	C 50	M 40	Y 40
75%	C 75	M 64	Y 64

UNCOATED

25%	C 25	M 18	Y 18
50%	C 50	M 43	Y 43
75%	C 75	M 68	Y 68

△ CMYK RECIPES — COMMON BLACKS & GRAYS when K-only isn't enough or the gray needs a temperature

NAME	C/M/Y/K	NOTE	NAME	C/M/Y/K	NOTE
Rich Black	60/40/40/100	deeper than K-only	Warm Gray 50	40/45/50/10	yellow-shifted
Super Black	75/68/67/100	max density	Cool Gray 50	55/45/40/10	cyan-shifted
Warm Black	40/60/40/100	shifts shadow warmer	Rich Warm Gray	40/50/55/25	deep warm neutral
Cool Black	70/50/30/100	shifts shadow cooler	3-Color Gray	40/32/32/0	no K, photo-clean

△ SPECTRO MEASUREMENT CONDITIONS pick one and stick with it across all readings

- M0** No UV filtering. Legacy only — use when matching old M0 data.
- M1** D50 with controlled UV. Standard for wide-format and sign work with OBAs.
- M2** UV excluded entirely. Compare colors without optical brightener effect.

VIEWING · D50 at 5000K, ~2000 lux, neutral surround (ISO 3664). Your eye lies under warm office light.

GOT A DRIFT? CLOSE IT.

Enter your target, what's on the printer, and your material. Drawdown returns the exact CMYK moves.

Free in your browser

drawdown.press